INCH-POUND

A-A-54808
12 February 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

NEEDLE, HYPODERMIC, Spinal Puncture

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-N-36546 which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers spinal puncture hypodermic needles suitable for use in administering spinal anesthesia.

Salient characteristics:

Classification. The needles shall be of the following gauges:

18 gauge
20 gauge
22 gauge

General. The needle shall be of the short bevel point design and shall consist of a hub, cannula, stylet and stylet knob.

Material. The needle and stylet shall be fabricated from Class 3, Type 304 stainless steel in accordance with ASTM F899.

Style, design and dimension. The needle shall be suitable for use in performing a spinal puncture. The needle cannula shall be securely swaged (not soldered) into the hub so as to be concentric with the hub cavity.

The tip of the needle point shall be ground to maximum keenness. The heel of the needle point shall be dull to prevent coring. The needle shall have a Luer lock hub in accordance with ISO 594.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The needle shall be fitted with a stylet. The stylet wire shall be securely swaged (not soldered) into the stylet knob. The stylet wire shall be capable of easy insertion and withdrawal from the needle. When inserted, the distal end of the wire shall be flush with the beveled point of the cannula.

The needle shall be 3-1/2 ± 1/8 inches in length and shall have the following dimensions:

GAUGE	OUTSIDE DIAMETER (Inch)	LENGTH OF POINT (Inch)	INSIDE DIAMETER AT POINT (minimum) Inch
18	.049 ± .0015	.125 ± .012	.032
20	.035 ± .001	.109 ± .011	.022
22	.028 ± .0005	.094 ± .009	.016

Security of assembly test. The needle cannula shall not crack or separate from the needle hub when subjected to a 10 pound axial tensile force exerted for one minute for a 22 gauge needle. For 18 and 20 gauge needles, the force shall be 15 pounds.

The stylet wire shall not crack or separate from the stylet hub when subjected to a 10 pound axial tensile force exerted for one minute for a 22 gauge needle. For 18 and 20 gauge needles, the force on the stylet shall be 15 pounds.

Elasticity. The needle cannula shall show no permanent set when bent 12 degrees from its rest position and then released.

Corrosion resistance. The needle and stylet shall show no signs of corrosion when tested in accordance with ASTM F1089.

Workmanship. The needle shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One needle of the sizes as specified, constitutes one unit.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspection are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Examination. Examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one spinal puncture hypodermic needle as specified. Sampling shall be inspection level II with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one spinal puncture hypodermic needle. Sampling shall be inspection level S-2 with an AQL of 1.0.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerance specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers and their respective Item Identifications are covered by this document:

NATIONAL STOCK NUMBERS	ITEM IDENTIFICATIONS
6515-00-350-5700	NEEDLE, HYPODERMIC, Spinal Puncture, 18 Gauge, 3-1/2 Inch
6515-00-350-5800	NEEDLE, HYPODERMIC, Spinal Puncture, 20 Gauge, 3-1/2 Inch
6515-00-350-5900	NEEDLE, HYPODERMIC, Spinal Puncture, 22 gauge, 3-1/2 Inch

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project Number: 6515-5508
Location: c:\word\doc\levin\needl3cd

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1 The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8 In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.

2 The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7

3 The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

RECOMMENDED CHANGE	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	A-A-54808	12 February 1993

3 DOCUMENT TITLE

NEEDLE, HYPODERMIC, Spinal Puncture

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER		
a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY		
a NAME Defense Personnel Support Center ATTN: DPSC-MSE	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (215)7372870	(2) AUTOVON 444-2870
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) 2800 South 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19145	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT. Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike Suite 1403 Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 *Previous editions are obsolete* '96

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.